GGG-S-284b
May 15, 1964
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-S-00284a (GSA-FSS)
August 8, 1961

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SHEARS; PRUNING, HAND, (ONE-HAND OPERATED)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. Hand pruning shears covered by this specification are those used for trimming shrubbery and similar woody growths. They are designed for one-hand operation.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, grades, and sizes.* Pruning shears covered by this specification shall be of the following types, grades, and sizes, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I.—Hook design (fig. 1).

Grade A.—Malleable iron or forged steel handles.

Size 7.—Minimum length 6-3/4 inches.
Size 8.—Minimum length 7-3/4 inches.
Size 9.—Minimum length 8-3/4 inches.

Grade B.—Cast iron, or equal, metal handles.

Size 9.—Minimum length 8-3/4 inches.

Type II.—Straight anvil design (fig. 2).

Grade A.—Stamped steel handles.

Size 7.—Minimum length 6-3/4 inches.
Size 8.—Minimum length 7-3/4 inches.

Grade B.—Die-cast zinc, aluminum alloy, or equal, metal handles.

Size 8.—Minimum length 7-3/4 inches.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

T-C-571—Cords, Cotton; General and Special Purpose, Sash & Venetian Blind.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals, Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools; Packaging and Packing of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design. The shears shall be constructed so as to effect a draw-cut action. They shall be designed for operation by one hand and shall conform to the types, grades and sizes as hereinafter specified.

3.1.1 *Illustrations.* The illustrations shown herein are for the convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of shears which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Blade. Blade shall be of good quality high-carbon or alloy steel, properly heat-treated, and tempered. The cutting edge shall be uniformly ground or polished throughout its length and sharpened ready for service without need for further attention.

3.2.1 *Hardness.* The hardness of the blade, determined in accordance with 4.4.1, shall be not less than 50 nor more than 60 on the Rockwell C scale.

3.2.2 *Toughness.* There shall be no chipping or cracking when any blade is subjected to the toughness test specified in 4.4.2.

3.3 Pivot bolt. The pivot bolt shall be fastened in such manner that there is no excessive looseness, sidewise movement or binding when shears are opened or closed. The bolt shall be suitably locked so that it will not work loose when the shears are in use.

3.4 Handles. The handles shall be free from burrs, fins, seams, rough edges and sharp corners and shall afford a comfortable handhold. When specified (see 6.1), the handles of pruning shears shall be equipped with soft grips made of plastic, rubber, or similar material.

3.5 Springs. Springs shall be of the volute, leaf, coiled, torsion, or formed wire type construction. The springs shall be tempered and shall be durable with sufficient strength to rapidly open the jaws of the shears from the closed position.

3.6 Latch. A positive latch shall be provided to hold the shears in a closed position. This latch shall be easily operated and shall prevent the shears from snapping open under normal handling. It shall lock the blade and hook so that there shall be no opening between their tips to injure the operator in handling or storage.

3.7 Cutting. The shears shall be subjected to the cutting tests described in 4.4.3. All cuts shall be readily and easily executed.

3.8 Finish. For type I shears, the blade shall have the inner surface properly ground and polished and the outer surface either ground, or polished, at the option of the contractor. For type II shears, the blades shall

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have both surfaces of the beveled portion properly ground and polished. The hook of type I shears shall have the inner surface properly ground and polished. Other metal parts, with the exception of the spring, shall have a polished finish, or a plated, painted, lacquered, japanned or synthetic-enameled finish, at the option of the contractor.

3.9 Marking. The shears shall be legibly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or with a trade-mark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.10 Type I. Type I shears shall be of the hook design and shall be similar to figure 1.

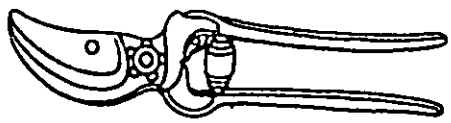


FIGURE 1.—Type 1, hook design pruning shear.

3.10.1 *Grade A*. Type I, grade A shears shall have either malleable iron or forged steel handles (see 3.4).

3.10.1.1 *Blade*. The blade shall be in accordance with 3.2. It may be separate from, or it may be an integral part of the handle; or welded or riveted to the handle. At the option of the contractor, or when specified (see 6.1), the blade shall be fastened to the handle lever in a manner that will permit it to be easily replaced by another blade of the same manufacture.

3.10.1.2 *Hook*. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the hook shall be of good quality high carbon or alloy steel, or malleable iron, properly heat-treated and tempered. The hook shall be either an integral part of, or welded to the handle lever or shall be fastened to the handle lever in a manner that will permit its replacement. If welded, the weld shall have full penetration and the line of weld shall be indistinguishable. The contour and length of the hook shall be such that when in the latched position, it shall act as a guard to prevent the point and cutting edge of the blade from injuring the operator.

3.10.1.3 *Sizes*. Type I, grade A hook design shears with malleable iron or forged steel handles shall be of the sizes specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.1). (At the option of the manufacturer, larger size shears of the same type and grade may be bid in competition with smaller sizes of shears.)

3.10.2 *Grade B*. Type I, grade B shears shall have either cast iron or equivalent metal handles. (Grade A shears with malleable iron or forged steel handles may be bid as grade B shears, at the option of the manufacturer, but not conversely.)

3.10.2.1 *Blade*. The blade shall be in accordance with 3.10.1.1.

3.10.2.2 *Hook*. The hook shall be of cast iron or equivalent metal and shall be otherwise in accordance with 3.10.1.2.

3.10.2.3 *Size*. The type I, grade B hook design shears, with cast iron or equivalent handles, shall be of 8-3/4 inch minimum length. (At the option of the manufacturer, larger size shears of the same type and grade may be bid in competition with smaller sizes of shears.)

3.11 Type II. Type II shears shall be of the straight anvil design and shall be similar to figure 2.

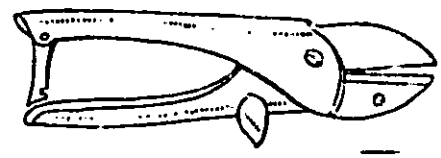


FIGURE 2.—Type II, straight anvil design shears.

3.11.1 *Grade A*. Type II, grade A shears shall have a stamped steel handle.

3.11.1.1 *Blade*. The blade shall be either an integral part of the handle lever, or at-

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tached thereto by welding, or fastened in the manner described in 3.10.1.1, at the option of the contractor. If welded, the weld shall have full penetration and the line of weld shall be indistinguishable. The blade shall be otherwise in accordance with 3.2.

3.11.1.2 *Anvil.* The anvil shall be of aluminum, brass, or bronze, at the option of the contractor, and shall receive the full length of the cutting edge of the blade in a groove or on a flat surface. The anvil shall be fastened to the handle lever in a manner that will permit it to be easily replaced by another anvil of the same manufacture.

3.11.1.3 *Sizes.* Type II, grade A straight anvil design shears with stamped steel handles shall be of the sizes specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.1). (At the option of the manufacturer, larger size shears of the same type and grade may be bid in competition with smaller sizes of shears.)

3.11.2 *Grade B.* Type II, grade B, shears shall have die-cast zinc, aluminum alloy, or equivalent metal handles. (Grade A shears with stamped steel handles may be bid in competition with grade B shears, at the option of the manufacturer, but not conversely.)

3.11.2.1 *Blade.* The blade shall be either an integral part of the handle lever, or attached thereto by welding, or shall be replaceable as described in 3.10.1.1, at the option of the contractor. If welded, the weld shall have full penetration and the line of weld shall be indistinguishable. The blade shall be otherwise in accordance with 3.2.

3.11.2.2 *Anvil.* The anvil shall be of good quality die-cast zinc, aluminum alloy, brass, or bronze, at the option of the contractor. The anvil shall be either an integral part of the handle lever, or it may be replaceable (see 3.11.1.2) at the option of the contractor. The anvil shall be either grooved or plain at the option of the contractor.

3.12 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class in every respect. The shears shall be free from defects and imperfections that might affect their durability or serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.2.1 *Inspection lot.* All pruning shears of the same type, presented at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection and tests.

4.2.2 *Sampling for inspection.* A random sample of pruning shears shall be taken from each inspection lot of material offered for inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics with lot acceptance based on the sampling requirements of Table I in accordance with the procedures of Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

TABLE I.—*Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection AQL (approx.) = 2.5 percent*

Number of pruning shears in the inspection lot	Sample size, number of pruning shears to be inspected (reference MIL-STD-105)
40 and under	Inspection level III
41 to 300	Inspection level II
301 and over	Inspection level I

4.2.2.1 *Sampling for tests.* A random sample of pruning shears shall be taken from each inspection lot in accordance with table II, and shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.4.

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TABLE II.—*Sampling for tests*

Number of pruning shears in inspection lot	Number of pruning shears in sample	Acceptance number (defectives)	Rejection number (defectives)
15 and under	3	0	1
16 to 40	5	0	1
41 to 110 ...	7	0	1
111 to 300 ...	10	0	1
301 to 800 ...	15	1	2
801 to 1,300 ..	20	1	2
1,301 and over .	30	2	3

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 *Visual and dimensional inspection.* Each of the sample shears taken in accordance with table I, shall be visually and dimensionally inspected by the inspector to verify compliance with this specification. Any shears in the sample containing one or more visual or dimensional defects shall be rejected and if the number of defectives in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. Rejected lots may be offered again for Government inspection provided the contractor has repaired or removed all nonconforming shears. The Government inspector shall again examine samples from such resubmitted lots to verify compliance with this specification.

4.3.2 *Testing* Sample shears taken in accordance with table II shall be subjected to the tests in 4.4. Any shears failing to meet any test shall be rejected and if the number of defectives in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. Rejected lots may be resubmitted for test provided the contractor presents evidence which the Government inspector considers sufficient to warrant further sampling for determining that all nonconforming shears have been removed or reworked so as to conform to this specification. The Government inspector shall again take samples from such resubmitted lots for inspection and tests to verify conformance to this specification.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Hardness of blades.* The hardness shall be determined for compliance with the requirements of 3.2.1, using a Rockwell tester with a diamond penetrator and employing a 150 kg. major load. Two or more determinations shall be made along the blade edge on each test sample in accordance with Fed Test Method Std. No. 151, method No 243.1, and all values so determined shall be within the limits specified.

4.4.2 *Toughness of blades.* The toughness of blades shall be determined by compliance with the requirements of 3.2.2. The shears shall be disassembled and the blade secured in a suitable support such as a vise with the cutting edge up. One end of a rod, 24 inches long and one inch in diameter shall be supported on a rest at approximately the same level as the cutting edge of the shear blade. The other end of the rod shall be elevated to a height of six inches above the cutting edge and released. The rod shall strike the cutting edge at a distance of two inches from the elevated end and at right angles to the plane of the blade. The rod shall be of No. 1020 steel.

4.4.3 *Cutting test.* The shears shall be subjected to either the sash cord or the green wood cutting test described in 4.4.3.1.1 or 4.4.3.1.2, and the paper test in 4.4.3.1.3. After being subjected to these tests the shears shall show no sign of distortion to any part, damage to the cutting edge, or indication of failure in any respect. Shears failing these tests shall be cause for rejection.

4.4.3.1 *Optional tests.*

4.4.3.1.1 *Sash cord test.* The shears shall cleanly cut 10 pieces of No. 1, braided cot-

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ton sash cord which conforms to the requirements of T-C-571. The cord shall be under sufficient tension to keep it taut.

4.4.3.1.2 *Green wood test.* The shears shall cleanly cut 10 pieces of green wood, approximately 5/16-inch diameter, without injury to bark.

4.4.3.1.3 *Paper cutting test.* After being subjected to the sash cord test or the green wood test the shears shall cleanly cut newsprint paper, 0.003 inch to 0.004 inch thick without tearing the paper.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Civil agencies. Fed. Std. No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Level A cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be in accordance with Level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Level C cleaning, preservation, and packaging shall be in accordance with the contractor's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Level B packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Shears, cleaned, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules or regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order (see 6.1), shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order (see 6.1), shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type, grade, and size required (see 1.2.1).

(*c*) If soft (cushion) grips are required, so state (see 3.4).

(*d*) If shears with replaceable blades are required (see 3.10.1.1).

(*e*) If specific material is required in the hook, state acceptable kind(s), (see 3.10.1.2).

(*f*) State level(s) of packaging and packing, required (see 5.1 & 5.2).

(*g*) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Shears, pruning.

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

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Motor:
Shears, pruning other than power.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—Mobility Command

Navy—None

Air Force—MOAMA (69)

Review Interest:

Air Force—MOAMA (69)

Army—MO

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.

QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED

DOLLAR AMOUNT
$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426

REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE

PLATE NO. 15419

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